

AFRIVATE TEAM SPACE — STAFF PORTAL GUIDE

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Audience	Team members (ordinary staff)
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This guide is **only for team members**. It covers what you can see and do. It does **not** cover Admin, recruitment, appraisals, or other People & Culture tools — you will not see those in the portal.

If you are a **team lead** or **assistant lead**, use AFRI-PUG-03 (Team Lead Portal Guide) instead. People & Culture and Administrators use the full AFRI-PUG-01.

1. WHAT THIS PORTAL IS FOR YOU

AfriVate Team Space is the official work website. You use it to keep a to-do list, request time off, send a weekly update, submit proof that you finished an Alison course, fill in surveys, keep your personal details up to date, read memos and policies, thank a colleague, and ask AVA how to do something.

The golden rule: If it needs a record (leave, weekly update, certificate, “I have read this policy”), do it in the Portal. Slack is for chat. WhatsApp is only for informal or emergency contact. A Slack or WhatsApp message is **not** an official leave request or weekly update.

Tool	You use it for
Portal	Records: leave, tasks, weekly updates, learning proof, surveys, shout-outs, your details, reading memos and policies.
Slack	Day-to-day questions and coordination. Reply to official Slack messages within four (4) hours on official work days.
Email (hr@afrivate.org)	Formal messages from People & Culture.
Alison	Taking the assigned course. Proof of completion goes in the Portal.
WhatsApp	Informal or emergency only — never leave, policies, or appraisals.
AVA	“How do I...?” She can open the right page. She never submits anything for you.

You will **not** see an **Admin** item in the menu. That is normal.

2. GETTING IN

Website: **portal.afriivate.org**

Request access (first time)

1. On the login screen, click **Request access**.
2. Enter your name, work email, and a password (at least 8 characters, one uppercase letter, and one number or symbol).
3. Choose your department and type your job title, then submit.

You wait until People & Culture approves you. Until then you may see a "waiting for approval" screen.

Sign in, password, account

Use your email and password, or ask for a **magic link** (an email link that signs you in without typing the password that time). **Forgot password** is on the login screen. After you are in: click your name (top-right) → **Account & security** to change email or password. **Sign out** is in the same menu.

3. FINDING YOUR WAY AROUND

On a computer the left menu shows: Home · My work · Inbox · People · Search · Weekly update · Getting started · Notes · Memos · Resources · Calendar. You will **not** see Admin.

On a phone the bottom bar shows Home, My work, Inbox, People, and More. Tap More for the rest.

Top bar: sun/moon (light or dark), Search, Availability (Available, Away, Busy, or Focusing), bell (Inbox), your photo (My profile, Account & security, Sign out). A banner may offer **Install AfriVate Portal** so it sits on your home screen like an app. The purple **AVA** button is bottom-right (on a phone, just above the bottom menu).

4. HOME

Path: Home (the first page after you sign in)

Home greets you and shows what needs attention: buttons for **New task**, **Request leave**, and **Submit check-in**; counts for tasks due today, unread memos, and events in the next 7 days; coloured banners if you have an open survey, a learning certificate due, or a policy you have not yet acknowledged; a Getting started progress bar if you joined in the last 30 days; today's events and the latest memos.

Start here each work day. Tap a banner to go do the thing. You will **not** see a number for "leave waiting on you to approve." That is for leads.

5. MY WORK (TASKS)

Path: My work

Your to-do list. You can create tasks, assign people, and mark work complete. The portal stores **who** completed a task and **when**. Views: Board (Up next → In progress → Complete / Stuck), List (by due date), Week.

1. Click **New task**. Give it a title. Add a description, people, due date, priority, category, hours, and blockers if you like. Save.

2. Open a task to update it. Move it **Up next** → **In progress** → **Complete**. If you are blocked, mark **Stuck** and write why.

Marking **Complete** in the Portal is the official record — do not only say so on Slack.

6. INBOX

Path: Inbox (or the bell)

Not email. Alerts **for you**: a shout-out, a task assigned to you, a mention, your leave approved or declined, a survey reminder, a new memo, or your access being approved. Tap an item to open the related page (it marks as read). Use **Mark all as read** to clear the red dot.

7. SEARCH

Path: Search

Type a name or word. You can find people, memos, tasks you can see, notes you can see, documents you are allowed to open, events, your leave, shout-outs, surveys, learning, and your OKRs. You will **not** see HR-only files, recruitment, or employee files. That is by design.

8. WEEKLY UPDATE

Path: Weekly update

Every week, tell the team what you **finished**, what is **next**, anything **blocking** you, and how many **hours** you worked. Choose who can see it: your **department**, or **everyone**.

Open **This week**, fill it in, submit. You can edit the same week later. **History** shows past weeks. You will **not** see a **Team** tab. That is for leads.

9. GETTING STARTED

Path: Getting started

Mainly for new joiners. Watch the welcome **videos** and tick the **checklist**. Home shows video progress for your first 30 days. Some checklist items tick themselves when you do the related Portal action. You cannot add or remove videos. People & Culture manage those.

10. NOTES

Path: Notes

Shared pages for meeting notes and how-we-do-things. Create a page, write in it, and choose who can see it: **Private**, **Workspace** (everyone), a **department** or **team**, or named people. Delete only when you are sure — it disappears for everyone who had access.

11. MEMOS (READ)

Path: Memos

Official company or team updates. Open Memos, read them, and mark as read. Home reminds you about unread ones. You **cannot** publish, edit, or delete memos. Team leads and People & Culture do that. If you need something announced, ask your lead. If your account is ever **suspended**, Memos is still readable (along with Resources).

12. RESOURCES (POLICIES AND FILES)

Path: Resources

1. Browse or search.
2. Preview or download.
3. If a file says you must acknowledge it, click that you have read it. Home and People keep a yellow banner until you do.

You **cannot** upload or delete files. You will **not** see HR-only files, and you will **not** see files marked for management only (those are for leads). If you are suspended, you can still read Resources.

13. CALENDAR (BROWSE)

Path: Calendar

See team events. Click one for time, place, and who it is for. Events may be for everyone or for your department. You **cannot** add or delete events. Team leads can.

14. PEOPLE HUB

Path: People

Tabs: Overview · Time off · Shout-outs · Learning · Surveys · Growth · My info · Directory. Overview is shortcuts plus the same reminder banners as Home, and recent HR digest memos. You will **not** see a team snapshot or a PIP & suspension list. Those are for leads.

15. TIME OFF (REQUEST LEAVE)

Path: People → Time off

This is the **only official way** to request leave. WhatsApp, Slack, a phone call, or “I’m off tomorrow” is not an approved request (except a true emergency — still record it here as soon as you can).

Type	Meaning	Typical allowance shown
Annual	Planned holiday	20 days
Sick	You are unwell	10 days
Emergency	Sudden, unavoidable absence	7 days

Give at least **three (3) official work days’ notice**, except accepted emergencies. Hand over work and tell colleagues on Slack before you go.

1. People → **Time off** (or Home → Request leave, or AVA → Go to Time off).

2. Click **Request leave**. Dates, type, reason. Attach a medical note or other file if needed.
3. Submit. Watch **My requests**: pending → approved or declined. You and your manager can comment on the request.

You will **not** see **Team requests** or a leave calendar of other people. Until the Portal says **approved**, you are not on approved leave.

16. SHOUT-OUTS

Path: People → Shout-outs

Thank a colleague in public. Compose a shout-out, pick the person, write a short message, pick a tag, add a photo if you like, and send. Others can like and comment. You cannot manage the tag list.

17. LEARNING (ALISON)

Path: People → Learning

You take the course on **Alison**. You **prove you finished** it in the Portal.

1. Open People → **Learning** and the Alison link.
2. Finish the course and save your certificate.
3. Back in the Portal: course name, completion date, upload the certificate (or pick from Google Drive). Submit.

Status is **pending** until HR reviews it. If they reject it, fix it and resubmit. A Home banner stays until your proof is in. You cannot assign courses to other people.

18. SURVEYS

Path: People → Surveys

When HR opens a Pulse, eNPS, or Onboarding survey, open People → **Surveys** (or the Home banner), answer, and submit. One response per person. Your individual answers go to HR. Your lead may see combined team scores, not your personal answers. You cannot launch surveys.

19. GROWTH (YOUR OWN)

Path: People → Growth

This is about **you**, not your team.

Tab	What you do
OKRs	Write your quarterly aims and key results. Slide progress as you go.
1:1s	Meet your manager outside the portal. You will see whether they have marked this month's 1:1 complete. You cannot mark it yourself.
IDP	Write your development plan and submit. If your manager leaves a note, you will see it.

Tab	What you do
Feedback	When HR opens a 360° cycle, complete the forms assigned to you.
Milestones	Tick your day 30 / 60 / 90 items when those conversations happen.
Awards	See quarterly award winners when they are announced.
Speak up	Raise a confidential workplace concern. HR receives it. Not for leave or IT niggles.

You will **not** see other people's OKRs, mark 1:1s for others, or review other people's IDPs.

20. MY INFO

Path: People → My info

You can save: preferred and legal name, personal email, phone, work location, country, date of birth, pronouns, LinkedIn, bio, skills, emergency contact, next-of-kin notes.

You cannot change: employment status, whether you are an employee / volunteer / contractor, probation dates, or payroll flags. People & Culture hold those.

Check the completeness percentage and click **Save my info**. If HR asked you to review your details, an amber banner stays until you save.

21. DIRECTORY

Path: People → Directory

The staff list. Search, open a profile, copy an email. Edit **your own** card (photo, bio, phone, skills, LinkedIn). You cannot edit someone else's profile. Availability comes from the top-bar control. You will not see other people's PIP or suspension badges. Leads and HR can.

22. AVA

Where: Purple AVA button

She explains how to do things and can show **Go to...** (Time off, Learning, Weekly update). She **cannot** submit leave, save a weekly update, approve anything, or see records you are not allowed to see. You always click the buttons yourself. If AVA is down, use this guide or email hr@afrivate.org.

23. IF YOU SEE A PIP OR SUSPENSION BANNER

People & Culture may place you on a Performance Improvement Plan or a suspension. You will see a banner at the top.

- **On PIP:** You keep using the portal as usual. Talk to your lead and HR.
- **Suspended:** You can still sign in. You can read **Memos** and **Resources**, and use **Account & security**. Everything else is paused until HR lifts it. If you open another page, you are sent back to Memos.

You cannot set these statuses. Only People & Culture can.

24. QUICK “WHERE DO I...?”

I want to...	Go here
Request leave	People → Time off
Submit my weekly update	Weekly update
Add or complete a task	My work
Read a memo	Memos
Acknowledge a policy	Resources (or the Home banner)
Submit my Alison certificate	People → Learning
Fill in a survey	People → Surveys
Update emergency contact	People → My info
Find a colleague	People → Directory or Search
Thank someone	People → Shout-outs
Write quarterly goals	People → Growth → OKRs
Raise a confidential concern	People → Growth → Speak up
Ask how to do something	AVA, then complete the action yourself
Change my password	Top-right → Account & security

25. A GOOD WEEKLY HABIT

1. Open **Home**. Clear banners (survey, learning, policy).
2. Request leave in the **Portal**, not WhatsApp or Slack.
3. Mark tasks **Complete** in My work.
4. Submit the **Weekly update** before the week closes.
5. Keep **My info** complete.
6. Use Slack for chat. Use the Portal when it must be on the record.
7. If you are lost, ask **AVA**, then do the click yourself.

26. IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

What you see	What to do
Waiting for approval	Wait, or email hr@afprivate.org .
Red banner: suspension	You can still read Memos and Resources. Contact HR if this looks wrong.

What you see	What to do
Amber banner: PIP	Keep using the portal. Talk to your lead and HR.
"We couldn't load your data"	Click Retry, then refresh if needed.
Magic / reset link expired	Request a new link from the login screen.
AVA does not answer	Use this guide in Resources, or email HR.

You cannot approve leave, publish memos, add calendar events, open Admin, or change anyone's role. If you need those things done, ask your **lead** or **People & Culture**.

Questions: hr@afprivate.org or your designated People & Culture representative.